

Trading Simplified

A From-Zero Trading Curriculum

Core philosophy: If a 13-year-old can't understand the explanation, the explanation isn't simple enough.

Starting point: Zero trading knowledge.

Practical goal: Become competent enough to read charts, understand markets, formulate a trading plan, and paper trade responsibly.

Important: We will not rush toward live trading. Understanding comes first, then chart reading, then simulation, then paper trading, and only much later would live money even become a consideration.

PHASE 0 — The Big Picture

Lesson 1 — What Is Trading?

- What trading actually is
- Trading vs investing
- How traders make and lose money
- Who is on the other side of your trade?
- Why prices move

Lesson 2 — The Financial Markets

Understand the major things people trade:

- Stocks
- ETFs
- Indexes
- Futures
- Forex
- Crypto
- Options
- Bonds

Goal: Know what each market is and why someone would trade it.

Lesson 3 — What Is an Asset?

- What exactly are you buying/selling?
- Shares

- Contracts
- Indexes
- Currency pairs
- Commodities

Lesson 4 — Buyers and Sellers

- Supply and demand
- Buyers vs sellers
- Why a price goes up
- Why a price goes down
- What "bullish" and "bearish" mean

Lesson 5 — The Price of Something

- Bid
 - Ask
 - Spread
 - Last price
 - Why the displayed price can change constantly
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PHASE 1 — Understanding Your TradingView Screen

This is where we start using the screenshot you provided.

Lesson 6 — TradingView From Scratch

Learn what every major part of the interface does:

- Chart
- Watchlist
- Symbol
- Timeframe
- Indicators
- Drawing tools
- Alerts
- Replay
- Settings
- Trading panel

Lesson 7 — What Is a Ticker?

Examples:

- AAPL
- TSLA
- SPX
- NQ
- MNQ

Learn how symbols identify different financial instruments.

Lesson 8 — Your First Chart

Understand:

- X-axis
- Y-axis
- Price
- Time
- Candles
- Volume

Lesson 9 — Timeframes

What:

- 1 minute
- 5 minute
- 15 minute
- 1 hour
- 4 hour
- Daily
- Weekly

actually mean.

Learn why the same market can look completely different depending on the timeframe.

Lesson 10 — Market Sessions

- Pre-market
- Regular market hours
- After-hours
- Overnight trading
- Why different markets operate differently

PHASE 2 — Candlesticks

This is one of the most important phases.

Lesson 11 — What Is a Candlestick?

Understand the four pieces:

Open

High

Low

Close

Lesson 12 — Green vs Red Candles

- What they actually mean
- Why green doesn't automatically mean "buy"
- Why red doesn't automatically mean "sell"

Lesson 13 — Candle Anatomy

- Body
- Upper wick
- Lower wick

Lesson 14 — Candle Time

Understand exactly what a 1-minute candle represents versus a 1-hour candle.

Lesson 15 — Reading a Single Candle

Learn what the candle can tell you about the battle between buyers and sellers.

Lesson 16 — Candle Patterns

Begin learning common patterns:

- Doji
- Hammer
- Shooting star
- Engulfing candle
- Pin bar

But importantly:

We will learn what these patterns mean rather than memorizing names.

PHASE 3 — How Markets Actually Move

Lesson 17 — Price Movement

Why does price move from \$100 → \$101?

Lesson 18 — Supply and Demand

The simplest explanation of why markets move.

Lesson 19 — Market Participants

Who participates?

- Retail traders
- Institutions
- Banks
- Hedge funds
- Market makers
- Algorithms

Lesson 20 — Liquidity

What liquidity means in plain English.

Why traders care about it.

Lesson 21 — Volume

- What volume actually measures
- High volume
- Low volume
- Volume spikes
- Why volume can matter

Lesson 22 — Volatility

What volatility means.

Why some markets move slowly while others can move violently.

PHASE 4 — Market Structure

This is where chart reading starts becoming much more interesting.

Lesson 23 — Trends

- Uptrend
- Downtrend
- Sideways market

Lesson 24 — Higher Highs & Higher Lows

Learn the basic building blocks of an uptrend.

Lesson 25 — Lower Highs & Lower Lows

Learn the basic building blocks of a downtrend.

Lesson 26 — Support

What support actually means.

Lesson 27 — Resistance

What resistance actually means.

Lesson 28 — Supply & Demand Zones

Understanding areas where buying or selling pressure may be concentrated.

Lesson 29 — Breakouts

What happens when price escapes an important area.

Lesson 30 — Fakeouts

Why a breakout doesn't always mean price will continue.

Lesson 31 — Pullbacks

Why price doesn't usually travel in a straight line.

Lesson 32 — Consolidation

Understanding when price gets "stuck."

PHASE 5 — The Language of Traders

You will gradually learn the vocabulary that currently makes trading seem complicated.

Lesson 33 — Bullish vs Bearish

Lesson 34 — Long vs Short

Lesson 35 — Entry vs Exit

Lesson 36 — Position

Lesson 37 — Stop Loss

Lesson 38 — Take Profit

Lesson 39 — Risk vs Reward

Lesson 40 — Drawdown

Lesson 41 — Win Rate

Lesson 42 — Expectancy

Lesson 43 — R-Multiples

Lesson 44 — Slippage

Lesson 45 — Commission & Fees

Lesson 46 — Leverage

Lesson 47 — Margin

PHASE 6 — Futures

Because your screenshot is showing **MNQ**, we will eventually need to understand futures properly.

Lesson 48 — What Is a Future?

Lesson 49 — Futures Contracts

Lesson 50 — Index Futures

Understand:

- ES
- NQ
- MES
- MNQ

Lesson 51 — What Is MNQ?

Break down exactly what the instrument on your screen represents.

Lesson 52 — Points vs Ticks

Lesson 53 — Tick Size

Lesson 54 — Tick Value

Lesson 55 — Contract Size

Lesson 56 — Futures Leverage

Lesson 57 — Why Futures Can Be Dangerous for Beginners

This is an important lesson.

PHASE 7 — Reading a Chart

Now we combine everything.

Lesson 58 — How to Read a Chart From Left to Right

Lesson 59 — Identify the Trend

Lesson 60 — Identify Important Levels

Lesson 61 — Identify Market Structure

Lesson 62 — Identify Momentum

Lesson 63 — Identify Consolidation

Lesson 64 — Identify Breakouts

Lesson 65 — Identify Pullbacks

Lesson 66 — Build a Chart Narrative

Instead of saying:

"The candles look bullish."

You'll learn to say something like:

"Price was trending upward, pulled back into previous support, buyers stepped in, and price broke the previous high."

That is the transition from **looking at charts** to **reading charts**.

PHASE 8 — Technical Analysis

Only after understanding raw price movement do we introduce indicators.

Lesson 67 — What Is Technical Analysis?

Lesson 68 — Moving Averages

- What they are
- Why traders use them
- What they do NOT tell you

Lesson 69 — RSI

- What it measures
- Overbought
- Oversold
- Common misconceptions

Lesson 70 — MACD

Lesson 71 — VWAP

Lesson 72 — Bollinger Bands

Lesson 73 — Volume Indicators

Lesson 74 — When Indicators Help

Lesson 75 — When Indicators Become Noise

Rule: We will never learn an indicator simply because "traders use it."

You will learn what problem it is attempting to solve.

PHASE 9 — Orders & Execution

Before paper trading, you need to understand how an order actually works.

Lesson 76 — Market Orders

Lesson 77 — Limit Orders

Lesson 78 — Stop Orders

Lesson 79 — Stop-Limit Orders

Lesson 80 — Bid/Ask Execution

Lesson 81 — Entering a Position

Lesson 82 — Exiting a Position

Lesson 83 — Stop Loss Execution

Lesson 84 — Take Profit Execution

Lesson 85 — Order Flow Basics

PHASE 10 — Risk Management

This may ultimately be more important than finding an "amazing strategy."

Lesson 86 — What Is Risk?

Lesson 87 — Why Position Size Matters

Lesson 88 — Risk Per Trade

Lesson 89 — Stop Placement

Lesson 90 — Risk/Reward

Lesson 91 — Losing Streaks

Lesson 92 — Drawdowns

Lesson 93 — Account Survival

Lesson 94 — Why One Bad Trade Can Destroy a Beginner

Lesson 95 — The Mathematics of Trading

Understand:

Win rate + average win + average loss = expectancy

PHASE 11 — Trading Strategies

Only now do we start talking about actual strategies.

Lesson 96 — What Is a Trading Strategy?

Lesson 97 — What Makes a Strategy Complete?

A strategy needs:

- Market
- Timeframe
- Setup
- Entry
- Stop
- Target
- Position size
- Conditions
- Rules for staying out

Lesson 98 — Trend Following

Lesson 99 — Breakout Trading

Lesson 100 — Pullback Trading

Lesson 101 — Support & Resistance Trading

Lesson 102 — Mean Reversion

Lesson 103 — Momentum Trading

Lesson 104 — Scalping vs Day Trading vs Swing Trading

Lesson 105 — How to Choose a Trading Style

PHASE 12 — Backtesting

Before trusting a strategy, test it.

Lesson 106 — What Is Backtesting?

Lesson 107 — Manual Backtesting

Lesson 108 — TradingView Bar Replay

Lesson 109 — Building a Trade Dataset

Track:

- Setup
- Entry
- Stop
- Target
- Result
- Time
- Market conditions

Lesson 110 — Sample Size

Why five successful trades prove almost nothing.

Lesson 111 — Win Rate vs Profitability

Lesson 112 — Avoiding Curve Fitting

PHASE 13 — Paper Trading

Now we move from theory into simulation.

Lesson 113 — Setting Up Paper Trading

Lesson 114 — Your First Simulated Trade

Lesson 115 — Following a Trading Plan

Lesson 116 — Recording Every Trade

Lesson 117 — Reviewing Your Trades

Lesson 118 — Finding Mistakes

Lesson 119 — Measuring Performance

Lesson 120 — Building a Trading Journal

PHASE 14 — Trading Psychology

This is where many beginners discover that knowing what to do and actually doing it are different things.

Lesson 121 — FOMO

Fear of missing out.

Lesson 122 — Revenge Trading

Lesson 123 — Overtrading

Lesson 124 — Fear of Losing

Lesson 125 — Greed

Lesson 126 — Confirmation Bias

Lesson 127 — Breaking Your Own Rules

Lesson 128 — Emotional Discipline

Lesson 129 — Thinking in Probabilities

Lesson 130 — Why Losing Trades Are Normal

PHASE 15 — Advanced Chart Reading

Once the fundamentals are solid, we can go deeper.

Lesson 131 — Multiple Timeframe Analysis

Lesson 132 — Market Regimes

Lesson 133 — Momentum vs Exhaustion

Lesson 134 — Liquidity Sweeps

Lesson 135 — Fair Value Gaps

Lesson 136 — Imbalances

Lesson 137 — Order Blocks

Lesson 138 — Market Structure Shifts

Lesson 139 — Volume Profile

Lesson 140 — Advanced Support & Resistance

We will be particularly careful here because trading social media is full of complicated terminology that often makes simple concepts sound mystical.

PHASE 16 — Fundamental Analysis

Technical analysis isn't the entire market.

Lesson 141 — What Moves Markets?

Lesson 142 — Economic News

Lesson 143 — Interest Rates

Lesson 144 — Inflation

Lesson 145 — Employment Data

Lesson 146 — Federal Reserve

Lesson 147 — Earnings

Lesson 148 — Economic Calendars

Lesson 149 — Why News Can Cause Huge Price Moves

PHASE 17 — Building YOUR Trading System

Now you stop being a student and start designing your own framework.

Lesson 150 — Choosing a Market

Lesson 151 — Choosing a Timeframe

Lesson 152 — Choosing a Setup

Lesson 153 — Defining Your Entry

Lesson 154 — Defining Your Stop

Lesson 155 — Defining Your Target

Lesson 156 — Defining Position Size

Lesson 157 — Defining When NOT to Trade

Lesson 158 — Creating Your Trading Checklist

Lesson 159 — Creating Your Trading Plan

PHASE 18 — Becoming a Data-Driven Trader

Lesson 160 — Trading Journal Analysis

Lesson 161 — Win Rate

Lesson 162 — Average Winner

Lesson 163 — Average Loser

Lesson 164 — Expectancy

Lesson 165 — Profit Factor

Lesson 166 — Maximum Drawdown

Lesson 167 — Finding Your Best Setups

Lesson 168 — Eliminating Your Worst Setups

PHASE 19 — TradingView Mastery

We will eventually learn the platform itself in depth.

Lesson 169 — Chart Layouts

Lesson 170 — Indicators

Lesson 171 — Drawing Tools

Lesson 172 — Horizontal Lines

Lesson 173 — Trend Lines

Lesson 174 — Channels

Lesson 175 — Fibonacci Tools

Lesson 176 — Alerts

Lesson 177 — Replay Mode

Lesson 178 — Watchlists

Lesson 179 — Multiple Charts

Lesson 180 — Paper Trading Interface

Lesson 181 — Saving Templates

Lesson 182 — Creating a Clean Trading Workspace

PHASE 20 — Final Beginner-to-Trader Project

At the end, you will complete a simulated trading project.

You will:

1. Choose one market.
2. Choose one timeframe.
3. Define one setup.
4. Create written entry rules.
5. Create written exit rules.
6. Define risk.
7. Backtest the strategy.
8. Analyze the results.
9. Paper trade it.
10. Journal the trades.
11. Review the data.
12. Modify the system only when the evidence supports it.

The objective is **not** to prove that you can make money.

The objective is to prove that you can follow a repeatable process.

THE LEARNING ORDER

We will NOT simply blast through 182 lessons.

The curriculum will operate in stages:

Stage 1 Understanding markets

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Stage 2 Understanding TradingView

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Stage 3 Understanding candles

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Stage 4 Understanding price movement

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Stage 5 Understanding market structure

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Stage 6 Understanding trading terminology

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Stage 7 Understanding futures

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Stage 8 Learning to read charts

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Stage 9 Technical analysis

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Stage 10 Risk management

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Stage 11 Strategies

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Stage 12 Backtesting

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Stage 13 Paper trading

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Stage 14 Psychology

↓

Stage 15 Advanced concepts

↓

Stage 16 Build your own trading system

HOW EACH LESSON WILL WORK

Every lesson will follow the same basic format.

1. The Simple Definition

One or two sentences explaining the concept like you're 13.

2. The Real-World Analogy

We'll use everyday examples whenever possible.

3. The Trading Explanation

How the concept actually works in a market.

4. The Chart Example

When useful, we'll connect it directly to your TradingView chart.

5. The Vocabulary

Only the new terminology you actually need.

6. The "Why Do I Care?" Section

Why traders care about this concept.

7. The Beginner Mistake

The most common misunderstanding.

8. Tiny Exercise

A simple question or chart-reading exercise to make sure you actually understand it.

THE INSTAGRAM CONTENT ENGINE

Your Instagram account can become a public record of the learning journey.

Instead of trying to pretend you're an expert, the positioning can essentially be:

"I'm learning trading from zero and explaining everything in plain English."

Each lesson can generate a short piece of content.

For example:

Lesson: What is a candlestick?

Instagram hook:

"Candlesticks look complicated. They're actually just 4 numbers."

Then explain:

Open
High
Low
Close

Another:

Lesson: What is leverage?

"Leverage is basically trading with a bigger position than your cash would normally allow.
Sounds great — until the market moves against you."

Another:

Lesson: Support

"Support isn't a magical line where the price HAS to bounce. It's simply an area where buyers have previously shown up."

This gives you a natural content pipeline:

LEARN → UNDERSTAND → SIMPLIFY → POST → TEACH → REINFORCE

Teaching the concept will also force you to understand it properly.

THE GOLDEN RULES OF THIS CURRICULUM

Rule 1

No jargon without translation.

If I say "liquidity," I immediately explain what liquidity means.

Rule 2

No memorization without understanding.

You won't memorize 50 candlestick patterns just because someone says you should.

Rule 3

No strategy before fundamentals.

You don't need a "secret strategy" when you don't yet know what a candle represents.

Rule 4

No live money.

We learn and eventually paper trade first.

Rule 5

No guaranteed profits.

There is no strategy that guarantees money.

Rule 6

Risk management comes before optimization.

Making a strategy slightly better is useless if one bad trade can destroy the account.

Rule 7

Simple beats complicated.

If two explanations describe the same thing, we'll use the simpler one.

Rule 8

You should be able to explain it yourself.

The real test isn't:

"Do I recognize the term?"

It's:

"Can I explain what it means without looking it up?"

WHERE WE BEGIN

We start with:

LESSON 1 — WHAT IS TRADING?

Not candlestick patterns.

Not RSI.

Not support/resistance.

Not "smart money."

Not strategies.

First, we're going to build the mental model of **what a financial market actually is and what is happening when you click Buy or Sell.**

Once that foundation is solid, everything else becomes significantly easier.

When you say "**Proceed**", we begin Lesson 1.